GALAPAGOS SKY

exceptional underwater adventures



Cruise Information Guide

Updated June 2026

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Welcome Aboard - Pre-Departure Guide

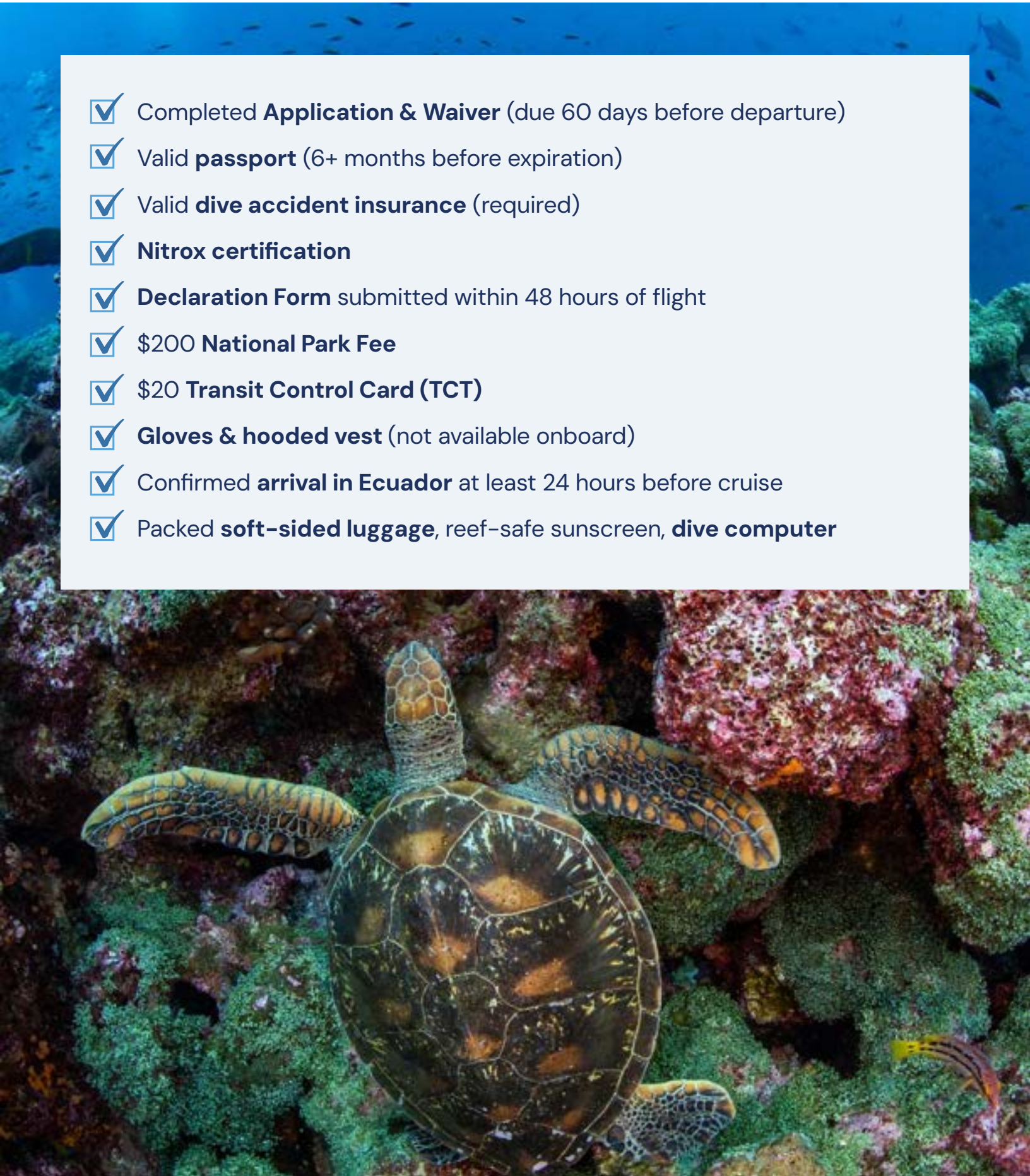


This guide has been carefully prepared to help you get ready for your diving expedition aboard **Galapagos Sky**.

Inside, you'll find essential information on travel logistics, entry requirements, what to pack, dive safety protocols, onboard services, and how to make the most of your journey.

While our team is here to support you every step of the way, we highly recommend reading this guide in full before your departure to ensure a smooth, safe, and unforgettable experience in the Galápagos Islands.

Before You Board: Final Checklist



- ☑ Completed **Application & Waiver** (due 60 days before departure)
- ☑ Valid **passport** (6+ months before expiration)
- ☑ Valid **dive accident insurance** (required)
- ☑ **Nitrox certification**
- ☑ **Declaration Form** submitted within 48 hours of flight
- ☑ $200 **National Park Fee**
- ☑ $20 **Transit Control Card (TCT)**
- ☑ **Gloves & hooded vest** (not available onboard)
- ☑ Confirmed **arrival in Ecuador** at least 24 hours before cruise
- ☑ Packed **soft-sided luggage**, reef-safe sunscreen, **dive computer**

1. Pre-departure Essentials

Entry Requirements

- Passport valid for at least 6 months after travel.
- Most travelers do not require a visa (check locally).
- Complete the Sworn Declaration Form within 48 hours of your flight.

Tourist Control Card (TCT)

- Mandatory for all travelers. Cost: $20 USD (cash only).
- Can be prepaid online or purchased at airport.

Galápagos National Park Fee

- $200 USD per person (cash only, in $10 or $20 bills).
- $100 USD for nationals of Andean Community or Mercosur.
- Can be prepaid through Galapagos Sky.

Note: If you booked your domestic flight and prepaid your T**ransit Control Card (TCT)** and **Park Entrance Fee** through the Galápagos Sky reservations team, **these items will be handled for you in advance**.

You will receive personalized airport assistance from our Ecoventura staff, and your documents (boarding pass, TCT card, and luggage tags) will be ready at check-in.

The information above is included for general awareness only.





2. Travel Logistics



Getting to Ecuador

- Fly into **Quito (UIO)** or **Guayaquil (GYE)**.
- Arrive by **Friday or Saturday morning** before cruise.
- Avoid Saturday night or Sunday morning arrivals.

Domestic Flights to Galápagos

- Fly to **San Cristóbal (SCY)** — not Baltra (GPS).
- Book Avianca flights through Galapagos Sky to receive:
  - Airport assistance
  - Prepaid TCT and Park Fee options
  - Luggage tags and boarding pass support

Note: 10-night cruises may **start in San Cristóbal and end in Baltra**, or **start in Baltra and end in San Cristóbal.** This will be confirmed in advance by the Sales Team.

Airport Assistance Contacts

After-hours e-mail: **help@ecoventura.com**

24/7 Telephone (WhatsApp only — calls or messages): **+593 96-977-2721**

We recommend downloading the WhatsApp app before starting your trip.

Quito:
Sebastián Bravo
+593 98-502-5818

Guayaquil:
Erika Parrales
+593 99-102-7100

3. Boarding & Embarkation

All guests must be onboard Galapagos Sky by **12:00 PM (noon)** local Galápagos time on Sunday. Boarding varies depending on your arrival arrangements:

If arriving on Avianca Flight 1630:

- You'll be met at **San Cristóbal Airport (SCY)** by our team.
- Transferred by **private van** to the Tiburón Martillo Ecotouristic Dock.
- Board the yacht via **panga** (inflatable tender).

If arriving earlier or on a different flight:

- Kindly make your own way to the **Tiburón Martillo Ecotouristic Dock** on San Cristóbal Island.
- **Meeting time: 12:00 PM (noon)** Galápagos time.
- The crew will be waiting to assist with your transfer by panga.

Important: Please ensure timely arrival. Late boarding is not possible due to National Park regulations and itinerary commitments.







4. Life Aboard Galapagos Sky







Yacht Features

- 16 guests maximum
- 8 cabins: 4 Master (upper deck), 4 Deluxe (lower deck), all with ensuite bathrooms
- 11 professional crew members
- Sun deck, indoor lounge, booth-style dining
- 2 flat screen TVs with Apple TV
- Charging station on dive deck
- Plug type: 110V (Type B – North America standard)
- Free Wi-Fi

Dining & Beverages

- **Breakfast & lunch:** Buffet-style
- **Dinner:** 4-course à la carte
- Snacks available throughout the day
- Ecuadorian and international menus using local, sustainable ingredients
- **Bar:** Beer, wine, spirits, juices, espresso, coffee & tea included

Special Dietary Requests

- Vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, dairy-free, no seafood (60-day notice) can be accommodated.

Sustainability

- Over 50% of food sourced from Galápagos
- Produce from San Cristóbal; meats and dairy from Santa Cruz

5. Diving in the Galapagos

Diving Conditions

- **Advanced diving only:** strong currents, surge, cold water, and thermoclines
- Water temperatures vary by season/ location:
- December–May: 65–80°F (18–27°C)
- June–November: 60–77°F (15–25°C)
- Average depth: 60–100 ft (18–30 m)
- All dives are **non-decompression**

Diver Requirements

- 50–100+ logged dives
- Recent dive activity (within last 6 months)
- Excellent buoyancy control
- Comfortable in cold water and currents
- Nitrox certification strongly recommended
- Dive computer required (plus backup if possible)
- Minimum age: 15 years

Not Permitted

- Solo diving, sidemount, doubles
- Night dives without proper lights and tank marker
- Stage/pony bottles

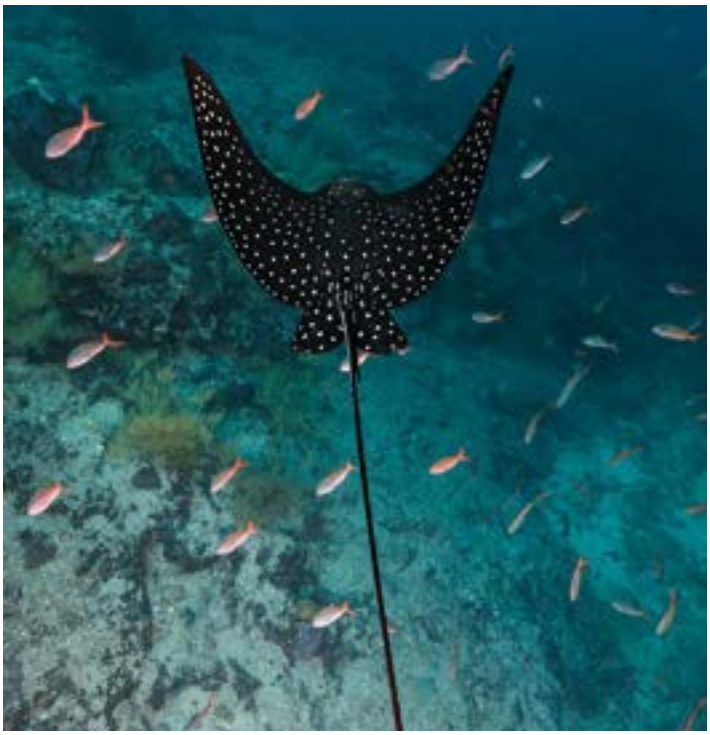






5. Diving in the Galapagos





Dive Procedures

- All dives from **panga**
- Enter via **back-roll** (some require negative entry)
- Exit: hand up gear, climb ladder
- 8 divers per guide
- Up to 4 dives per day on 5.5 days (7-night itinerary)

Nitrox (32%)

- Required
- Must analyze and log each tank
- Certification card required
- No training onboard

Private Dive Guide (Optional)

- 7-night: $1,950 | 10-night: $2,800
- Must be pre-booked and prepaid
- They will act as the client's dedicated dive buddy, or may instead be paired with another diver, partner, or family member designated by the client and will remain within assigned group for safety.



6. Gear & Rentals

Provided Onboard

- 80 cu ft aluminum tank
- Weights + weight belt
- Towels, eco toiletries
- Separate rinse bins (gear/cameras)
- Heated towels + storage bins

Not Available Onboard

- Cameras, gloves, hoods, dive lights, reef hooks, dry suits, stage/pony bottles

Full Gear Rental Package

- Includes: BCD, regulator, wetsuit, mask/snorkel, fins/booties
- **7-night:** $250
- **10-night:** $360

Payment due onboard (cash or card)

À La Carte Rental Items

7-night rates:

BCD	$80
Computer	$80
Regulator + Gauge	$75
7mm Wetsuit	$45
Mask & Snorkel	$25
Fins & Booties	$25
100 cu ft Tank Upgrade	$60

10-night rates:

BCD	$115
Computer	$110
Regulator + Gauge	$115
7mm Wetsuit	$65
Mask & Snorkel	$35
Fins & Booties	$35
100 cu ft 15 ltr tank upgrade	$85



7. Safety & Insurance

Required Safety Equipment
- Surface Marker Buoy (SMB)
- Audible signaling device
- Nautilus Lifeline (MMSI: 735057585)

Insurance Requirements
- Dive accident insurance is mandatory
- Must provide policy info in Application

Hyperbaric Chamber Fee
- $35 USD, prepaid
- Funds the facility in Puerto Ayora
- Does not cover treatment costs

Travel Insurance
- Highly recommended (includes trip cancellation, medical, “Cancel for Any Reason”)

No-Fly Time
- Last dive: Saturday morning
- 18–24 hour surface interval before Sunday flights

8. Payment & Gratuities

Included
- Accommodations, meals, drinks
- 3 land excursions
- Airport transfers
- Diving (tank & weights)

Not Included
- Airfare, insurance, Nitrox, rental gear
- Park fee, TCT, chamber fee
- Hotels, tips

Gratuities
- Suggested: 10% of cruise rate
- Given in cash or credit card (Visa, Mastercard or American Express)
- Tips are shared by all crew

9. Packing List

Essentials

- Passport
- Certification cards
- Insurance info
- Reusable water bottle
- Soft-sided luggage
- USD cash (small bills) + credit card

Clothing

- T-shirts, shorts, long pants
- Swimsuits, sleepwear
- Jacket/sweater
- Hat, sunglasses
- Walking shoes
- Robes provided onboard

Dive Gear

- 7mm wetsuit or drysuit
- Hooded vest + gloves
- BCD, reg, mask, snorkel
- Fins/booties
- Computer + backup
- Logbook, SMB, whistle
- Dive light (optional)
- Save-a-dive kit

Personal Care

- Reef-safe sunscreen
- Toiletries, feminine products
- Seasickness meds
- Hairdryer provided







10. Disembarkation

Sunday – San Cristóbal

- Visit to Interpretation Center
- Luggage transferred to airport
- Crew assists with hotel or airport transfers

Saturday (Optional – 10-night cruises only)

- Early disembarkation possible at Baltra
- Must notify Sales Team in advance
- Flights out of Baltra do not operate Saturday PM





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Contact Information

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5805 Waterford Drive, Suite 160, Miami, FL 33126

+1 (305) 262-3483

Mon–Fri, 9 AM–5 PM EST

Ecoventura – Ecuador Offices

Guayaquil: Km 1.5 vía Samborondón

+593 4 283-9390

Sales Team – Galapagos Sky: info@galapagossky.com

Travel Assistance (outside office hours)

Phone & WhatsApp: +593 98 894 8912

We look forward to welcoming you aboard Galapagos Sky.

Happy bubbles!